

Backwards Planning – Understanding by Design Planning Template

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Stage 1—Desired Results

Established Goal(s)

Big Goal: Students will be able to identify common elements of folk tales, primarily in the tradition of magic tales (fairy tales), and apply their understanding by creating an original or adapted story or illustrated scene that demonstrates these elements with a reflective artist statement citing their creative choices.

Final assessment

A creative project attempting one of the following:

- a. Rewrite the story (Jackalope Wives) to be more like a folk tale (identify how these changes make it more like a folk tale)
- b. Write an original folk tale using folk tale elements (at least 2-3)
- c. Create an illustrated scene or cover demonstrating folk tale elements

Students then write a reflection explaining:

- a. Their project
- b. At least 2–3 folk tale elements included and how they used them

The criteria for this assessment will be:

1. Demonstrate understanding of and use at least 2 elements of folk tales.
2. At least 1-2 pages of work reflecting Criteria 1.
3. A short (Half a page) reflection that shows thought process and explains the project.

Other Ungraded Assessments

- A graphic organizer showing where folk tale elements appear in Jackalope Wives (Day 2) Collected, but returned on Day 3.
- An exit ticket on day 1, in writing notebooks.

TEXT: <https://www.apexbookcompany.com/a/blog/apex-magazine/post/jackalope-wives>

TEXT: <https://sites.pitt.edu/~dash/swan.html> Second version, the small Swedish one.

MAIN: **RL.9-10.9** Analyze how an author alludes to and transforms source material in a specific work (e.g., how Shakespeare treats a theme or topic from Ovid or the Bible or how a later author draws on a play by Shakespeare).

RL.9-10.2 Analyze literary text development. (A) Determine a theme of a text and analyze in detail its development over the course of the text, including how it emerges and is shaped and refined by specific details.

Side-practice (We aren't explicitly assessing for this but they'll be practicing it): **W.9-10.3** Write narratives to develop real or imagined experiences or events using effective technique, well-chosen details, and well-structured event sequences.

Understanding(s):

Students will understand that...

Folk tales, particularly magic tales (fairy tales), are built from identifiable elements.

These elements function to develop the plot, convey themes, and to reveal moral lessons.

Essential Question(s):

What makes a story a folk tale?

How do magic tale elements contribute to its meaning?

Students will know... (SKILLS) How to identify and explain common folk tale elements. How to analyze those elements and how they can influence the story's meaning. How to apply folk tale elements to creative works.	Students will be able to... (Strategies) Identify common folk tale elements in a text by using a graphic organizer to mark instances of magical events, archetypal characters, and other elements in Jackalope Wives. The teacher will model identifying a couple elements, then will gradually release students do identify on their own. CFS: Students should correctly identify and label at least two-three elements. Analyze how folk tale elements shape plot and theme by summarizing key events and annotating how magical events, characters choices, or lessons influence what happens next in the story. This will be modeled through class discussions and think-alouds linking elements to plot and theme. CFS: Students should explain how at least two-three elements impact or influence the story's meaning Apply generic elements to creative works by creating their own creative project (options listed in assessments) and writing an artist statement explaining their thought process. CFS: 2-3 elements in their creative work and meaningful reflection in the artist statement.
Stage 2—Assessment Evidence	

Performance Task(s): Main Final Assessment A creative project attempting one of the following: - Rewrite the story (Jackalope Wives) to be more like a folk tale (identify how these changes make it more like a folk tale) - Write an original folk tale using folk tale elements - Create an illustrated scene or cover demonstrating folk tale elements Students then write a reflection explaining: Their project At least 2–3 folk tale elements included and how they used them The criteria for this assessment will be: Demonstrate understanding of and use at least 2 elements of folk tales. At least 1-2 pages of work reflecting Criteria 1. A short (Half a page) reflection that shows thought process and explains the project.	Other Evidence: Other assessments throughout the mini-unit, including check for understandings / exit tickets. A graphic organizer showing where folk tale elements appear in Jackalope Wives (Day 2) Collected, but returned on Day 3. An exit ticket on Day 1, in writing notebooks
Stage 3—Learning Plan	

Learning Activities: [List the daily objective(s) for each day].

Day One:

Students will identify and categorize common folk tale elements by completing a graphic organizer, focusing on the Swan Maiden text.

Students will describe key folk tale elements by answering an exit ticket: What are common folk tale elements?

Day Two:

Intro ticket: What makes a story a folk tale?

Students will identify characteristics of folk tales by reading and discussing Jackalope Wives as a class.

Students will identify textual evidence of folk tale elements by highlighting where these elements appear in Jackalope Wives.

Day Three:

Students will finish analyzing how folk tale elements function in Jackalope Wives by reading the text and engaging in class discussion about where and how they appear.

Students will evaluate a text by identifying whether or not it has folk tale elements.

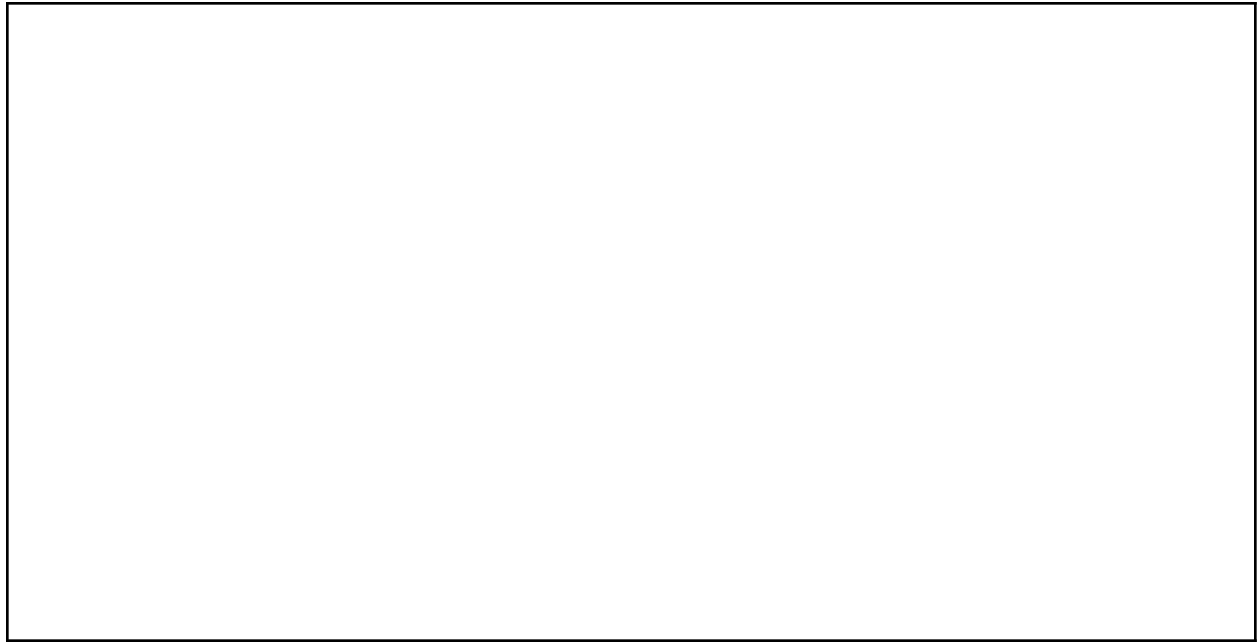
Day Four:

Students will apply their understanding of folk tale elements by creating an original or adapted story or an illustrated scene incorporating two-three elements.

Students will explain their creative choices by writing an artist statement describing how their project uses specific folk tale elements.

Day Five:

Students will create and finish their project that demonstrated understanding of folk tale elements by completing and submitting their finalized work.



Research

[Folk tale distinction](#)
[podcast on folktales](#)

sent in the titles of French translations of the Grimms' tales.

The designation *fairy tale* is problematic for students of folk narrative. In English that term is at the same time a synonym for the adjectives *fantasy*, *magical*, *ideal*, *fictitious*, or *untrue*; and in common usage a designation for essentially any kind of make-believe story, especially one with a marvelously happy ending. But strictly speaking, *fairy tale*, applied to such traditional tales as "Hansel and Gretel" or "Little Snow-White," is a misnomer. These are tales of magic, but no fairies are involved.

In conclusion, the expression *fairy tale* is a relative latecomer in English and does not accurately translate the original French, German, and Danish titles of some of our most popular "fairy-tale" collections. Furthermore, most stories known today as fairy tales are not about fairies at all, even though they do typically rely on magic powers for their resolution. A more accurate and historically more consistent designation would be *magic tale*, a term with close parallels in German (*Zaubermärchen*), French (*contes merveilleux*), and other languages. The label *magic tale* is preferred by specialists, but *fairy tale* is by now thoroughly established in English, and I will not attempt to dislodge it. Fairy tales, or magic tales—I shall use the terms synonymously—are an important part of a larger genre called collectively *folk narratives*, and it is to that broader category that we now turn.

[elements of folk tales](#)

<https://www.nls.uk/collections/stories/literature-and-poetry/fairy-tale-elements-and-structure/>

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZUR-YGLRs_o